CROCHET PATTERN

Pastel Rainbow Cloud Ornament

A crochet rainbow arch and puffy cloud on a beaded cord with a rainbow tassel



SKILL LEVEL	FINISHED SIZE	YARN	HOOK
Intermediate	≈ 21 cm (8.3 in) plus an 8 cm loop	DK cotton · 7 colours	2.5 mm (US B/1–C/2)

A five-colour rainbow arch worked in one piece in rows, set into a lightly stuffed cloud made from two joined pieces, hanging above a striped rainbow tassel.

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MATERIALS · GAUGE · ABBREVIATIONS

Before You Begin

Materials & Tools

Yarn A (pink)	DK (#3) cotton — approx. 3 m (4 yd), about 2 g — 1 ball of 50 g (about 115 m) is enough
Yarn B (peach)	DK (#3) cotton — approx. 3 m (4 yd), about 2 g — 1 ball of 50 g (about 115 m) is enough
Yarn C (yellow)	DK (#3) cotton — approx. 3 m (4 yd), about 2 g — 1 ball of 50 g (about 115 m) is enough
Yarn D (mint)	DK (#3) cotton — approx. 3 m (4 yd), about 2 g — 1 ball of 50 g (about 115 m) is enough
Yarn E (blue)	DK (#3) cotton — approx. 3 m (4 yd), about 2 g — 1 ball of 50 g (about 115 m) is enough
Yarn F (cloud, cord, tassel neck)	DK (#3) cotton, cream — approx. 9 m (9 yd), about 4 g — 1 ball of 50 g (about 115 m) is enough
Yarn G (tassel only)	DK (#3) cotton, lilac — approx. 3 m (4 yd), about 2 g — 1 ball of 50 g (about 115 m) is enough
Hook	2.5 mm (US B/1–C/2)
Beads	1 gold-tone beads 6 mm (hole at least 2.5 mm); 2 natural wooden beads 12 mm (hole at least 3 mm). Both cord strands must pass through each bead together — test before you start.
Notions	fiberfill (a little), tapestry needle, stiff card for the tassel, pins, scissors

Gauge

GAUGE 22 sc and 24 rows/rnds = 10 cm (4 in) in single crochet with a 2.5 mm hook. Gauge is not critical for an ornament, but work firmly so that stuffing does not show and flat pieces keep their shape; sizes depend on your tension.

How to swatch: Optional density check: ch 12, then work 10 rows of sc on 11 sts. The square should measure about 5 cm (2 in) wide and 4 cm (1.6 in) tall. If it is larger or you see gaps between stitches, use a smaller hook.

Finished Measurements

Part	Width	Height
Rainbow arch	≈ 5.3 cm (2.1 in)	≈ 4.7 cm (1.9 in)
Cloud (lightly stuffed)	≈ 6.7 cm (2.6 in)	≈ 3.4 cm (1.3 in)
Tassel	–	10 cm (4 in)

CHOOSING A SIZE One size. For a larger ornament use light worsted (#4) cotton and a 3 mm hook; for a smaller one use sport-weight cotton and a 2 mm hook. Beads and tassel length can be changed freely.

Abbreviations (US terms)

ch	chain	**dc**	double crochet
sc	single crochet	**st(s)**	stitch(es)
inc	2 sc in the same stitch	**rnd(s)**	round(s)
sl st	slip stitch	**( ) xN**	work the sequence in brackets N times

Pattern Notes

- Joined rounds (where a round says "Join"): start the round with ch 1, which does not count as a stitch, and finish it with a sl st into the first stitch.
- US crochet terms are used throughout.
- The number in parentheses at the end of a row or round is the number of stitches you should have when it is finished. Tick the box when you finish each step.
- Rows: ch 1 at the start of a row does not count as a stitch; rounds worked in a magic ring are worked in continuous spirals unless the round says "join".
- Leave a 20 cm (8 in) tail when you fasten off a piece that will be sewn; weave in all other ends on the wrong side as you go.

Techniques

Colour change — Work the last stitch in the old colour until 2 loops remain on the hook, complete it with the new colour. Cut the old colour leaving a 10 cm tail and weave it in on the wrong side.

Joining two pieces with sc — Hold the pieces wrong sides together with the edges matching. Insert the hook through the stitch or row-end of BOTH pieces at once and work the sc as usual, so one round of sc joins and edges them.

Tassel neck wrap — Lay a 5 cm loop of the wrapping strand along the tassel, pointing down. Wrap the long end tightly around tassel and loop, from the top down. Pass the end through the loop, then pull the short tail at the top until the loop disappears under the wraps. Trim both ends and hide them in the skirt.

YARNS E, D, C, B, A · MAKE 1

Rainbow Arch

The arch is worked in one piece in rows, starting with the inner (blue) arc. Each row adds 3 sts in the middle while the first and last 4 sts stay straight, so the strip curves into an arch with straight legs. Change colour at the end of every row.

☐	**Row 1**	With Yarn E (blue), ch 16. Sc in 2nd ch from hook and in each ch across. Change to Yarn D (mint) in the last st; ch 1, turn.	**(15)**
☐	**Row 2**	sc 5, (inc, sc 1) x2, inc, sc 5. Change to Yarn C (yellow) in the last st; ch 1, turn.	**(18)**
☐	**Row 3**	sc 5, inc, sc 3, inc, sc 2, inc, sc 5. Change to Yarn B (peach) in the last st; ch 1, turn.	**(21)**
☐	**Row 4**	sc 6, (inc, sc 3) x2, inc, sc 6. Change to Yarn A (pink) in the last st; ch 1, turn.	**(24)**
☐	**Row 5**	sc 6, inc, sc 5, inc, sc 4, inc, sc 6. Fasten off.	**(27)**

TIP Weave the colour tails into the row they belong to on the back. Pin the arch into an even semicircle and steam it lightly before joining it to the cloud.

YARN F (CREAM) · MAKE 2 PIECES, THEN JOIN

Cloud

Cloud piece (make 2)

☐	**Row 1**	Foundation: make a chain of 14. Sc in 2nd ch from hook and in each ch across. Ch 1, turn.	**(13)**
☐	**Rows 2–4**	sc 13. Ch 1, turn (3 rows).	**(13)**
☐	**Row 5**	Bumps: sl st in first st, (skip 1 st, 7 dc in next st, skip 1 st, sl st in next st) x3. Fasten off.	**(25)**

Joining round

☐	**Rnd 1**	Hold the two cloud pieces wrong sides together, bumps at the top, and slide the rainbow legs 1.5 cm (0.6 in) down between them, centred. With Yarn F, work through both layers (and through the legs where they sit): 3 sc in the first corner of the foundation edge, sc in each of the next 11 foundation ch, 3 sc in the last corner, sc in each of 4 row-ends up the side, sc in each sl st and dc across the bumps, sc in each of 4 row-ends down the other side.	**(50)**
		Before closing the last 10 sts, stuff the cloud lightly so it stays flat. Join with a sl st to the first sc and fasten off.	

YARNS A–E, G; YARN F FOR NECK AND CORD

Tassel

The tassel is made first: the hanging cord is tied into its top, so the cord runs through the whole ornament and is anchored in the tassel.

☐	**Step 1**	Cut a piece of stiff card 21 cm (8.3 in) tall. Wrap each of Yarns A, B, C, D, E and G around the card 7 times, one colour next to the other in rainbow order (42 wraps). Cut the yarn at the bottom edge.
☐	**Step 2**	Cut the hanging cord: one 100 cm (39 in) length of Yarn F (cream). Slide it under all the wraps along the top edge of the card so that its middle sits there, and tie it in a tight square knot around the wraps. Both cord ends now point upwards.
☐	**Step 3**	Cut through all the wraps along the bottom edge of the card and remove the card. Let the strands hang down from the cord knot.
☐	**Step 4**	Tassel neck: cut a 70 cm length of Yarn F. Measure 2 cm down from the top fold and wrap it tightly 8 times around the bundle (see Tassel neck wrap in Techniques).
☐	**Step 5**	Trim the skirt evenly to 10 cm (3.9 in) from the top fold. Hold it over steam (or dampen it) and comb the strands straight with your fingers; let it dry hanging.

Assembly & Finishing

- Thread both cord ends together through a large-eye tapestry needle (or a bead needle with a big eye). Work upwards from the tassel.
- String, from the tassel upwards: 1 wooden bead → 1 gold bead → the cloud and rainbow → 1 wooden bead.
- Cloud and rainbow: push the needle up through the cloud from the centre of its bottom edge to the centre of the dip between the bumps, take the cord up through the opening of the arch and out through the top of the arch between the 2 middle sts of the last row.
- Push everything down snugly onto the tassel so there are no gaps. Holding both cord ends together, tie one overhand knot right above the top bead to lock the stack.
- Hanging loop: tie the two cord ends together with a square knot so that the loop measures 8 cm (3 in) from the overhand knot to the top. Trim the ends to 5 mm and add a drop of fabric glue to the knot if you like.

SAFETY This is a decoration, not a toy, and not suitable for children under 3 years. Beads and cords are a choking and strangling hazard: hang it out of reach of babies, young children and pets.

Checkpoints & Troubleshooting

Stop and count at these points — every number is the stitch count on your needle after that step, exactly as printed in the rows.

Piece	Count	One size
Rainbow Arch	after: Row 1	15
	after: Row 2	18
	after: Row 5	27
Cloud piece (make 2)	after: Row 1	13
	after: Row 5	25
Cloud: joining round	after: Rnd 1	50

If your count doesn't match

- **Count at every checkpoint.** One stitch out: look back to the last checkpoint for a missed or doubled increase or decrease and put it right there. A lifeline (a smooth thread run through a finished row) lets you rip back safely to a row you know is right.
- **Piece longer or shorter than expected for the rows:** your row gauge differs. Lengths are worked to the measurement given, so measure the piece flat, without stretching, and follow the cm.
- **Working in rounds:** place a marker at the start of the round and move it up every round — most count errors in rounds come from a lost round start.

THANK YOU Thank you for making this ornament. Happy crocheting!